

HYPOGLYCEMIA

1. Definition

Hypoglycemia is a medical emergency and must be treated rapidly to avoid mortality. It occurs when blood glucose levels fall below 0.50 g/dl (2.5 mmol/l). It is a complication of treatment with insulin and/or certain oral antidiabetics.

2. Circumstances of discovery

Symptoms :

Feelings of weakness, drowsiness, restlessness, sweating, trembling, hunger, anxiety, irritability, dizziness.

3. Common causes hypoglycemia

- More physical exercise than usual
- Delayed, skipped meals or omitted snacks
- Poor insulin injection technique
- Insufficient carbohydrate consumption
- Heavy alcohol consumption
- Dosing errors on oral antidiabetic drugs

4. Case management :

a) If the patient is conscious:

Give glucose orally, **starting with fast sugars:** juice, lemonade, bombs, cooking sugar, and then add **slow sugars:** bread, pasta, beans, rice, etc.

b) If the patient is unconscious: Infuse 5%, 10%, 30% glucose until consciousness is regained, or Glucagon ampoule 1mg IM if available.

c) Upon awakening, try to identify and properly treat the cause hypoglycemia, otherwise refer the patient.